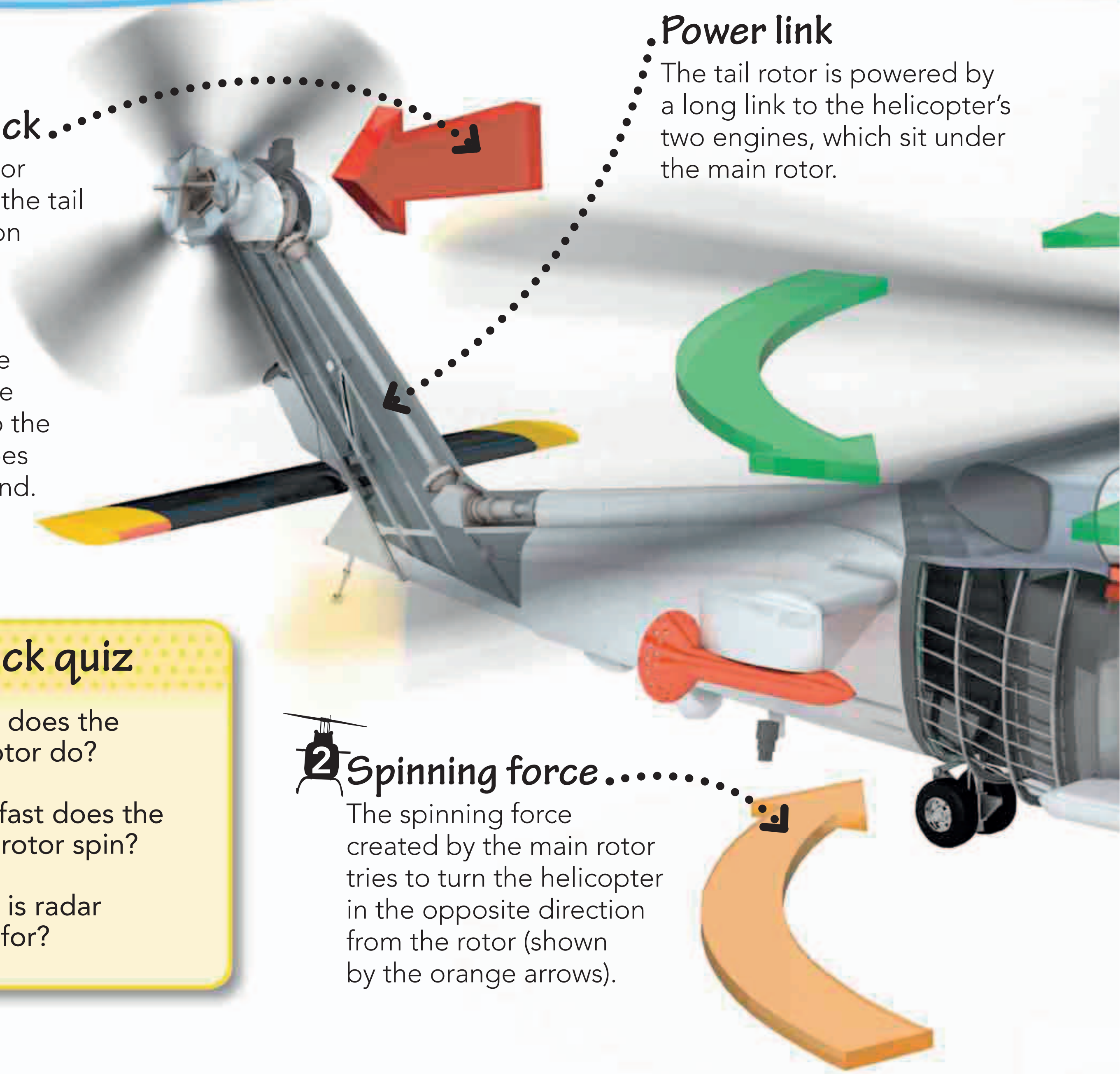

3 Pulling back
As the tail rotor spins, it pulls the tail in the direction of the red arrow. This balances the spinning force created by the main rotor, so the helicopter does not spin around.

Power link
The tail rotor is powered by a long link to the helicopter's two engines, which sit under the main rotor.

Quick quiz
- What does the tail rotor do?
- How fast does the main rotor spin?
- What is radar used for?

2 Spinning force
The spinning force created by the main rotor tries to turn the helicopter in the opposite direction from the rotor (shown by the orange arrows).

Why does a helicopter have a propeller on its tail?

The propellers are actually called rotors, and most helicopters have two of them—the main rotor and the tail rotor. The main rotor lifts the helicopter off the ground. It also creates a spinning force that tries to spin the whole helicopter around. The tail rotor's job is to stop that from happening.